

Charles Darwin

Making a MONKEY of mankind

Darwin showed that the complexity of life on Earth is the result of millions of years of gradual change and not of a single act of biblical creation.

Early years

Charles Darwin was born into a wealthy family in Shrewsbury, England, in 1809. As a young man Darwin wanted to be a **doctor**, but he **hated** the sight of blood, so he studied religion instead.

He learned about **Natural Theology**, which taught how God designed life on Earth... but he would soon question this idea.



An incredible voyage

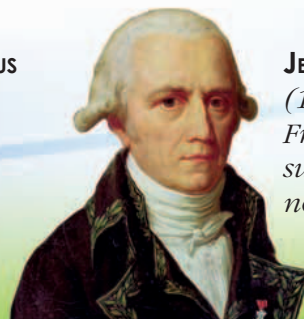
When he was just 22, Darwin joined a scientific expedition on a ship called HMS *Beagle*. He spent the five-year voyage **observing nature**, which included making notes and collecting samples. While visiting the **GALÁPAGOS ISLANDS** in the Pacific Ocean, Darwin noticed that animals that were obviously related looked slightly different on different islands.

He couldn't have done it without...

The finches that started Darwin thinking have become a symbol for evolution.



Swedish botanist **CARL LINNAEUS** (1707–1778) came up with the modern way of grouping related species together, also known as **TAXONOMY**.



JEAN-BAPTISTE LAMARCK (1744–1829) was a French naturalist who suggested that species were not fixed but could **EVOLVE**.